



HARVESTING

The longer you leave scallions in the ground, the bigger the bulbs will grow. If you want them at their youngest and most delicate, you can start harvesting as soon as the onions reach approximately 6 in (15 cm) high. Harvest bunching onions as required, either when young and slender, or leave to mature and thicken.

STORING

Although scallions do not store well, they will keep fresh in the refrigerator for a few days. For best results, pick them for immediate use.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Scallions and bunching onions are vulnerable to the same problems that afflict larger varieties of onion (see pp.316–7). Downy mildew and onion white rot are the most common diseases; remove infected plants and destroy, as there is no effective cure. To reduce the risk and spread of disease, practice good garden hygiene and keep plants well ventilated.

You may also need to cover your seedlings with fleece to protect them from onion fly. Scallions and bunching onions grown from sets are less at risk.